

Groundwater Extraction in Peri-Urban Districts

Findings and recommendations

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1 Executive summary

Groundwater extraction in the surveyed districts exceeds natural recharge by an estimated 34 percent. Without intervention, three of the eight blocks studied will reach critical depletion within a decade.

2 Methodology

2.1 Sampling frame

Measurements were taken at 412 observation wells across eight administrative blocks, sampled quarterly over three years.

2.2 Instrumentation

Instrument	Count	Precision
Automatic loggers	180	1 cm

3 Findings

3.1 Extraction against recharge

Net depletion was observed in six of eight blocks.

3.2 District variation

Variation between districts is larger than variation within them.

4 Recommendations

1. Meter all agricultural connections above 5 HP within eighteen months.
2. Move the subsidy from electricity units to metered water volume.